



KNOW HOW



Q I have the Fedora 11 DVD that came with your magazine. I am currently using Windows Server 2003, which I would like to remove and replace with Fedora 11 for DNS and proxy servers. However, I don't know how to create the DNS with Fedora 11. Please guide me on how to create the DNS server for my institute.
—Dange Laxmikant, Nanded, Maharashtra

To install and configure the DNS server, you need to install the BIND (Berkeley Internet Name Domain) DNS server. The best way to install BIND is by using the *yum* package manager as follows, after making sure you're connected to the Internet:

```
#yum install bind
```

This will install all necessary packages. Now go through the documentation on BIND at http://www.redhat.com/docs/en-US/Red_Hat_Enterprise_Linux/5.4/html/Deployment_Guide/ch-bind.html and configure your server.

You can also install Squid to make your Fedora 11 a proxy server using *yum*. Here are the steps for a basic Squid installation and configuration:

```
#yum install squid
```

Open the */etc/squid/squid.conf* in any text editor and define an ACL

(access control list). The following is an example of an ACL statement:

```
acl my_network src 192.168.1.0/24
http_access allow my_network
```

Remember to change the IP address as per your network. The default port is TCP 3128, which you can change by putting the following statement in the file:

```
http_port 8080
```

Now save and close the file before starting the Squid server as follows:

```
# /etc/init.d/squid start
```

Run the following commands so that Squid starts automatically when you reboot your system.

```
# chkconfig squid on
```

On the client machine, open a Web browser and configure it to use the proxy settings.

You can go through the *squid.conf* file and make other changes as per your requirements.

Q I have installed CentOS 5.3 on my server. I often use yum to install and update packages. I want to know if there is any way I can just download all the RPMs that are needed to install a package along with its dependencies.

—Mohan M, Chennai

In order to only download packages using Yum, you need to install the *yum-downloadonly* plug-in:

```
# yum install yum-downloadonly
```

Now, run the following command:

```
# yum update firefox -y --downloadonly
```

This will download and store the packages in the */var/cache/yum/* directory. You can even specify a directory of your choice, as follows:

```
# yum update firefox -y --downloadonly \
--downloadaddr=/tmp/lfy/
```

yum will download all the packages needed to update Firefox, but will not install any of them. Instead, it will quit with a message after the download is complete, similar to what is shown below:

```
exiting because --downloadonly specified
```

Q I use Fedora Core 6 on one of my systems. I often face problems while unmounting my CD-ROM drive. I get a message stating that the device is busy, even when I run the *eject /dev/hdc* from a terminal. Please help me resolve the issue.

—Neelam, Kanpur

Try the following command...

```
# fuser -km /dev/hdc
```

...and then:

```
# eject /dev/hdc
```

This should work!

Q I'm really new to Linux. I want to play MP3 files. Please guide me through the whole procedure and terminal commands.

—Syed Aamiruddin, by e-mail

Please follow the steps given in the following site: <https://help.ubuntu.com/community/RestrictedFormats> 